

Flower Dedication

The flowers that adorn the sanctuary today are given in honor of our children and grandchildren, Ben, Jacy, Christian, Katty, Dustin, Maddox, Christian, Pierce, and Clay. — Alberto & Marianne Albarracin

Announcements

Roca Blanca Mission Trip (September 26 – October 3): We will have a full team meeting tonight, Sunday, August 9, at 7:00 p.m. in the Fellowship Hall. We need all team members to plan on attending. We currently have 2 openings for the trip — if you are interested in filling one of these spots, please attend the meeting tonight. We would love to have a full team of 30. Please pay Courtney Monaghan for the balance of the trip by August 14.

Church Fellowship Night: Sunday, August 16 — let’s meet in the Sanctuary at 5:30 p.m. for Family Worship, followed by a Church Potluck Dinner in the Fellowship Hall. Chicken tenders will be provided; please bring your favorite dish, side, or dessert. A nursery will be available for children up to 3 years old. Please fill out the sign-up insert in today’s bulletin and drop it in the offering plate.

Women’s Bible Study: Register for the upcoming 9-week study, *“What’s She Doing Here?”* by Susan Tyner. Two options to attend: Tuesdays at 8 a.m. beginning August 18, or Wednesdays at 6 p.m. beginning August 19. Email Laura Kate at lkcarmichiel@fpccorinth.org to register.

Men’s Intensive 3 (MI3): *A Better Way to Live* — begins this Thursday, August 13.

Register today! A 7-week commitment to pre-read material and show up on 7 Thursdays at 6 a.m. for 7 conversations with 7 other men you should know but may not. Register at MI3Corinth.eventbrite.com or scan the QR code.



Scan to register

Those Who Serve Today

Assisting Elder — Dr. John Shipp
Greeters — Michael & Laura Giaccagliini
Acolytes — Brandon Giaccagliini & Will Sanders

Ushers — Trey Tull, Don Williams, Brent Johnson, Hack Smith, & Hayden Worsham
Nursery — Deborah Kiddy, Laurin Porter, Courtney Monaghan, Maribel Albarran, Leslie Fisher, & Lauren Butler
AV Engineer — Russell Smith

Church Staff

Rev. Waring Porter - Pastor
Gregg Parker - Dir. of Discipleship
Bobby Capps - Dir. of Outreach & Care
Jennifer Shipp - Dir. of Student Ministries
Laura Kate Carmichiel - Dir. of Women’s Min. & Comm.

Phyllis Sellers - Day School Director
Jan Pike - Choir Director
Malachi Doren - Accompanist
Teresa Tsagarakis - Administrative Assistant
Sammy Allred - Bookkeeper

The Church Calendar

August 9 Roca Blanca Team Meeting, 7 p.m.
August 10 Youth Bible Studies Restart
August 12 Wednesday Night Youth Restarts
August 13 MI3 Begins
August 14–15 Officer Spouse Retreat
August 16 Deacons’ Meeting · Church Fellowship Night, 5:30 p.m.

Online Giving



Scan to give online



FIRST PRESBYTERIAN CHURCH

August 9, 2026

Eleventh Sunday after Pentecost

“To be disciples, to make disciples”

Welcome

We Are Glad You Are Here!

We are honored that you decided to join us this morning. Whether it is your first time in church, your first time in a long while, or part of your regular rhythm, we hope you will be encouraged by the fellowship with each other, and with our Lord, as we worship him together.

If this is your first time with us, please take a moment and fill out a Next Steps Card found on the back of the pew. We would love to meet you and help you get connected.

Children & Nursery

Children (age 4+) and their families worship together in the sanctuary, where children will be dismissed to Children’s Church during the service. Children’s bulletins and crayons are available at both entrances to the Sanctuary. Children are always welcome in worship!

Nursery rooms for infants through age 3 are in the Education Wing, with the entrance behind the playground on the west side of campus. If you have a newborn and/or are nursing your baby, please feel free to use our baby room just off the narthex — a quiet space with comfortable seating where the worship service is broadcast as well.

Our Vision & Mission

Our vision is to see lives transformed by the power of the gospel, rooted in God’s Word and the Reformed tradition, in order to create a culture of discipleship at FPC where disciples WORSHIP holistically, GROW relationally in Christ, and SERVE boldly in the world for the glory of God. Our mission is to accomplish this by “Being Disciples and Making Disciples.”

Connect With Us

Website: fpccorinth.org
Phone: 662-286-6638
Address: 919 East Shiloh Rd, Corinth, MS 38834

Sermon Outline

“Restored by Grace: God’s Providential Care”

Rev. Waring Porter · Ezra 6:1–12

Imagine if the rebuilding of God’s house depended on locating one government record that had been filed away nearly twenty years earlier in one of the largest empires the world had ever known. If that document isn’t found, the rebuilding almost certainly comes to an end. God’s promises appear to be hanging by a thread. As we read the story, we might be tempted to think, “Well, I hope they get lucky.” But there is no luck in Ezra 6. There is only providence.

What is fascinating is that there are no dramatic miracles in this chapter. Instead, we watch what seems like an ordinary day inside a government office. On the surface, it looks like politics and paperwork. But behind every ordinary event stands the extraordinary hand of Almighty God. Ezra 6 reminds us that what appears to depend on earthly rulers is, in reality, governed by the sovereign Lord of heaven and earth. In Reformed theology, we call this God’s providential care.

WSC, Question 11: “What are God’s works of providence?” — “They are his most holy, wise, and powerful preserving and governing all his creatures, and all their actions.”

I. Directs the Decisions of Earthly Rulers (vv. 1–5)

II. Provides Everything Necessary for His Mission (vv. 6–10)

III. Protects His Covenant Purposes (vv. 11–12)

“Semper reformanda secundum Verbum Dei” — always reforming, according to the Word of God

Resources: Matthew Henry’s Commentary, Vol. 2, Matthew Henry; Ezra & Nehemiah, Derek Kidner; Ezra & Nehemiah, Jacob M. Myers

DGROUP

A group of 3–5, same-gender individuals, led by a trained disciple-maker, that meets regularly to encourage one another as Christ-followers to continue taking steps in becoming a disciple of Christ who makes other disciples.

dGroup Story of Grace

Gregg Parker, Dir. of Discipleship

LITURGY FOR THE WORSHIP OF GOD

August 9, 2026

* Indicates congregation standing if able

GATHERING

The Piano Prelude

Greetings & Announcements

Call to Meditation: Isaiah 41:10

“Fear not, for I am with you; be not dismayed, for I am your God; I will strengthen you, I will help you, I will uphold you with my righteous right hand.”

The Prelude

PRELUDE

The prelude provides a quiet moment to prepare for worship. As the music begins, we are encouraged to calm our hearts, focus our minds, and enter reverently into God’s presence.

Choral Introit

“Blessed Assurance”

*Call to Worship: Psalm 103:19–22

Leader: The Lord has established his throne in the heavens, and his kingdom rules over all. Bless the Lord, O you his angels, you mighty ones who do his word, obeying the voice of his word! Bless the Lord, all his hosts, his ministers, who do his will! Bless the Lord, all his works, in all places of his dominion.

All: Bless the Lord, O my soul!

*The Hymn: #25

“Immortal, Invisible” (vv. 1–3)

HYMN

Written by Walter Chalmers Smith in 1867, this hymn exalts God’s eternal majesty, wisdom, and sovereign rule over all creation. As we sing, we are reminded that the Lord is the unseen King who “reigns in light inaccessible” and accomplishes His perfect purposes through all earthly events. In Ezra 6, God even directs the decrees of pagan kings to protect and provide for His people, assuring us that His providential care always advances His kingdom and preserves His church.

WORD

The Giving of Tithes and Offerings

Choral Anthem

“I Feel the Spirit!” (traditional spiritual)
Additional words, Nancy Price; arr. Don Besig

*The Doxology and Prayer of Dedication

Praise God, from whom all blessings flow; Praise Him, all creatures here below;
Praise Him above, ye heavenly host; Praise Father, Son, and Holy Ghost. Amen.

*Children Dismissed to Children’s Church

CHILDREN’S CHURCH

Children ages 4 up to 4th grade are invited to come forward and exit out the side door for Children’s Church. Following the worship service, they may be picked up in the Fellowship Hall.

Scripture Reading

Ezra 6:1–12 · Pew Bible, p. 392

Scripture Response: Isaiah 40:6b, 8

Leader: All flesh is grass, and all its beauty is like the flower of the field;
All: The grass withers, the flower fades, but the Word of our God will stand forever.
Amen.

Sermon: “Restored by Grace: God’s Providential Care”

Rev. Waring Porter

Prayer of Commitment

SENDING

*Closing Hymn: #52

“O God, Our Help in Ages Past” (marked verses)

*Benediction

*Choral Benediction

Benediction (2 part)

*Postlude

***Prayer of Invocation & The Lord’s Prayer**

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy Kingdom come, thy will be done on earth, as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors. Lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, the power, and the glory, forever. Amen.

***Responsive Reading:** from Romans 8:28–39

Leader: And we know that for those who love God all things work together for good, for those who are called according to his purpose. For those whom he foreknew he also predestined to be conformed to the image of his Son, in order that he might be the firstborn among many brothers. And those whom he predestined he also called, and those whom he called he also justified, and those whom he justified he also glorified.

All: What then shall we say to these things? If God is for us, who can be against us? He who did not spare his own Son but gave him up for us all, how will he not also with him graciously give us all things?

Leader: Who shall bring any charge against God’s elect? It is God who justifies. Who is to condemn? Christ Jesus is the one who died, more than that, who was raised, who is at the right hand of God, interceding for us. Who shall separate us from the love of Christ? Shall tribulation, or distress, or persecution, or famine, or nakedness, or danger, or sword?

All: No, in all these things we are more than conquerors through him who loved us. For I am sure that neither death nor life, nor angels nor rulers, nor things present nor things to come, nor powers, nor height nor depth, nor anything else in all creation, will be able to separate us from the love of God in Christ Jesus our Lord.

***Congregational Response: #25**

“Immortal, Invisible” (v. 4)

Corporate Prayer of Confession

Sovereign and gracious Father, You rule over the nations, establish kingdoms, and accomplish all Your holy will. Yet we confess that we often doubt Your providence. We fear the power of people more than the power of God. We become anxious about tomorrow, seek to control what belongs in Your hands, and question Your wisdom when Your purposes are hidden from us. Forgive us for our unbelief and our pride. Grant us humble hearts that trust Your perfect rule, rest in Your faithful care, and gladly submit to Your will. Through Jesus Christ, our gracious King and Savior, we pray.

Silent Confession

Assurance of Divine Pardon: Romans 8:31–32

“What then shall we say to these things? If God is for us, who can be against us? He who did not spare his own Son but gave him up for us all, how will he not also with him graciously give us all things?”

***Gloria Patri**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son: and to the Holy Ghost; As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be: world without end. Amen.

***Profession of Faith:** The Apostles’ Creed

I believe in God, the Father almighty, Maker of heaven and earth, and in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Ghost, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead and buried; he descended into hell; the third day he rose again from the dead; he ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty; from thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead. I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.*

**that is, the true Christian church of all times and all places*

**CORPORATE
CONFESSION**

Our corporate confession of sin is a three-fold acknowledgement that the world is not the way it was meant to be; I am not the way I was meant to be; and we as a church are not the way we were meant to be. As we acknowledge our failures together, we testify to the world that the gospel is rooted in the faithful mercy of God alone. This is the most honest moment of our week, as we humbly agree with Scripture’s claim that all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God.

THE APOSTLES’ CREED

The Apostles’ Creed is a concise summary of the Christian faith, affirming the Triune God — Father, Son, and Holy Spirit — and the redeeming work of Jesus Christ. It connects us with the historic church and provides a clear, biblical confession that strengthens our unity and directs our worship.